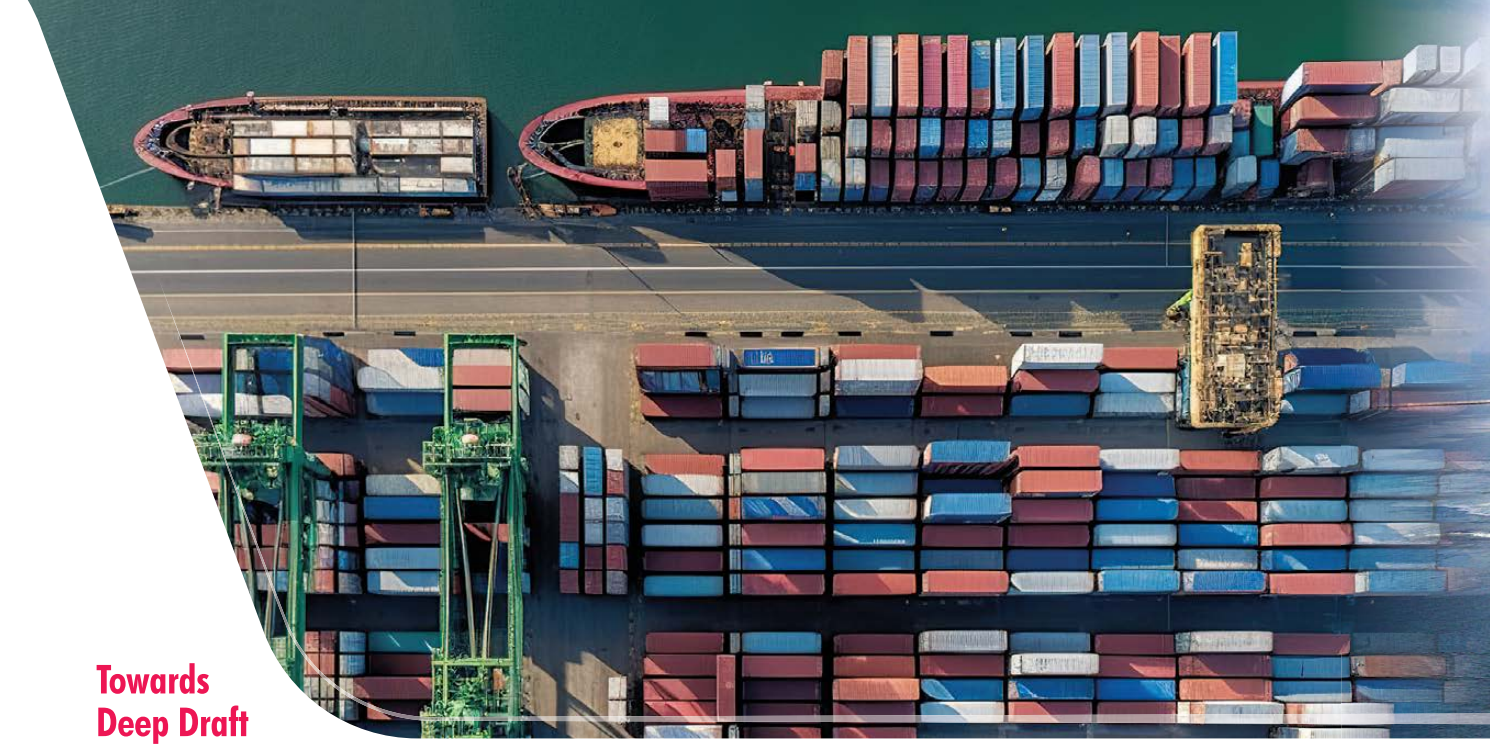


Towards Deep Draft Mega Ports

Going forward the government is focussing towards the strategic development of cutting-edge **Deep Draft Mega Ports** and **Trans-shipment Hub** as outlined in the Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047 which is a comprehensive blueprint, launched recently by Hon'ble PM during the Global Maritime India Summit 2023. Against the backdrop of a global trend where ports are expanding their handling capacities to manage increased traffic, there is a significant potential to strengthen India's capability in the domain of port logistics and become competitive with other leading maritime nations such as Netherlands and other South-East Asian regions to drive a greater share of global EXIM trade. The shipping industry is moving towards **mega size vessels** which would require higher draft at ports. Considering the evolving shipping market, ship sizes, and cargo profile, it is essential for the Indian Ports to further strengthen port infrastructure and drive a greater share of global EXIM trade. The cargo traffic handled at Indian ports is expected to increase significantly on account of economic growth, increase in modal share of cargo in coastal and inland waterways and development of industrial clusters at ports, which will necessitate a cargo handling capacity of **10,000 million tonnes** per annum by 2047.

In pursuit of this strategic imperative, India is marching ahead with development of Mega Ports through augmentation of existing ports along with development of new ports. Each of these ports is strategically positioned to fortify India's maritime capabilities, contributing to the nation's vision of becoming a maritime powerhouse on the global stage. Some of the key port include **Paradip Port** in Odisha, Visakhapatnam Port in Andhra Pradesh, Vadhavan Deep Draft All Weather Port in Maharashtra, Outer Harbour at V O Chidambarnar Port in Tamil Nadu, Bulk Cargo Transhipment Hub at Atlanta Bay in North Andaman Island and International Container Trans-shipment Port (ICTP) at Galathea Bay in Greater Nicobar Island.

Paradip Port in Odisha, which is the largest among the major ports in India, has emerged as the Coastal Hub of the Country with a rated capacity of **289 million tonnes per annum**. Achieving the **highest berth productivity** among major ports in FY 22-23 at 31,050 tonnes per day, Paradip Port contributed 30% of the total incremental cargo among major ports, registering the **highest incremental cargo** of 19.2 million tonnes. Strategic projects like the **Western Dock project**, berths NDC-3 & 4, South-western dock for dry bulk cargo, and a clean cargo terminal underscore Paradip Port's commitment to modernization and expansion. The Port has also embraced green initiatives, aiming to achieve a **million trees by 2025**, 100% mechanized cargo handling by 2030, and clean energy sources, including a 10 MW solar power plant. In a ground-breaking move towards sustainability, Paradip Port aims to become a **Green Hydrogen and Ammonia Hub**. MoUs worth Rs. 50,800 Cr. have been signed with investors like ReNew E-Fuels, EG Solwin Hybrid, L&T Energy, and Welspun New Energy to establish green Hydrogen and Ammonia Facilities near Paradip Port. The Port plans to develop an **exclusive green hydrogen and green ammonia berth** with an annual capacity of 5 million tonnes by 2026, costing Rs. 325 Cr.



Paradip port plans to emerge as a Mega Major Port of the country by streamlining operations, investing in infrastructure for capacity expansion and fostering strategic partnerships with stakeholders. The port adopted customer centric approach, with highest berth productivity and lowest tariff among all ports in the country. The Port is now diversifying to become a Green Hydrogen & Ammonia Hub also. With the projects in pipeline, including the green and smart endeavours, Paradip Port will evolve as a Green and Smart Mega Port of the country.

Sh. P. L. Haranadh, IRTS
Chairman, Paradip Port Authority

Visakhapatnam Port, another Mega port on the east coast has recently celebrated its 90th year of service to the nation. With an annual cargo handling capacity of 137 million tonnes, the port has achieved remarkable improvements in key performance parameters in FY 2023-24. Notable achievements include a **9% increase** in cargo volumes, a 69% reduction in pre-berthing detention, a **13% reduction** in turnaround time, a 12% improvement in output per ship berth day, and a 12% reduction in idle time at berth. The port is evolving as a **regional trans-shipment hub on the East Coast**, handling 4.63 Lakh TEU during FY24 with a 42% growth in volumes. Through PPP initiatives, the port is rapidly transforming into a **Landlord Port**, contributing about **60%** of the total throughput handled at the Port at **PPP operated berths**. With an additional investment of about **Rs. 700 Crores**, three new PPP projects are set to augment handling capacity by another **15 million tonnes per annum** by the end of 2025. By 2030, VPA aims to handle about 75% of the total throughput through PPP Terminals, inching towards **100% PPP** in line with **Maritime India Vision 2030**.

One of the most ambitious projects of the government, the **Vadhavan Deep Draft All Weather Mega Port Development** envisages construction of state-of-the-art facilities with an overarching capacity of **25 million TEUs** and an impressive **draft of 20 meters**, this port will be suited for accommodating large container vessels with a capacity of up to **25,000 TEUs**. This ambitious undertaking is strategically positioned to propel India into the coveted league of the Global Top 10 Container Ports. With an estimated project cost of **Rs. 76,220 Crores,** the port will be developed on Landlord Model, implemented through Public-Private Partnership (PPP). This model leverages private sector expertise and investment, fostering efficiency and sustainability in the port's operations and development. The port's **strategic location** on the west coast, positioned at a **short distance**